CONFIDENTIAL

OneXtel

Product State & Direction Report

Prepared for

Leon & Tarik

From

Udayan Das Chowdhury, Director of Products

May 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report consolidates findings from five independent data sources: a full product teardown of the Aura platform, analysis of **7,139 customer support tickets**, **376 production incident tickets** raised in the last 7 weeks (JIRA PROD project), the **JIRA AURA project backlog** covering active development across SMS, WhatsApp/RCS, I2I, ILDO, Government, and UAE platforms, and a **competitive landscape review** of the $21–23B global CPaaS market.

Three findings define the situation:

> *1. Aura is a strong infrastructure business with a weak product surface. The routing, delivery, and operator connectivity layer is genuinely world-class. The customer-facing product on top of it is not. Customers use Aura to send messages — they do not use it to understand, improve, or automate their communications.*

> *2. The product is losing enterprise deals it should be winning. RBAC, Maker-Checker, and Audit Logs are absent from every platform. These are not feature requests — they are procurement requirements for every BFSI and Government customer. Deals are being lost because of their absence, not because of pricing or channel coverage.*

> 3. *The path forward is clear. OneXtel is not a redesign of Aura. It is the product layer that Aura never built — surfacing Aura's infrastructure through an engagement platform that customers actually want to use daily.*

Part 1 — What Aura Is Today

The Product in One Sentence

Aura is a **telecoms operator console** built for ops teams verifying SMS delivery, not for marketers building customer relationships. The current UI (onexaura.com) reflects this — the sidebar reads: Dashboard · Campaign · User Management · Credits · Channels · Reports · Telco Reports · DLT · API · Phonebook · Config. The dashboard is a bar chart of Submitted/Delivered/Failed/Awaited counts by day of week. It is a monitoring tool, not an engagement tool.

Full Feature Inventory — What's Actually Shipped

SMS Platform (V2)

- DLT Template Management (full PE-TM chain binding)

- Single Endpoint API, Sender ID + Entity ID mapping
- Bulk campaigns: file upload, dynamic, scheduling
- Reports: Summary, Detailed, Sender ID-wise, Template, Campaign, Latency, Clicker
- CRM Plugins: CleverTap, MoEngage, WebEngage live; Shopify + LeadSquared in progress
- 2FA login, Global Number Blacklist/Whitelist, Data Masking
- Error Code Mapping (customer + platform level), Pull API

WhatsApp + RCS Platform (WARCS)

- Embedded Signup, OBO (On-Behalf-Of), RCS Bots, auto credit-line attach
- Templates: LTO, Carousel, Product Catalog, Flows (~90–95% of Meta/VI/Jio spec)
- Campaigns: multi-file, exclude file, duplicate check, scheduling, test, repeat, batching, clone
- Link Tracking + URL Shortener (web + API, button + body)
- APIs: Send Template, Non-Template, Create/Fetch Template, Status Check, Media Upload
- Multi-provider setup (WA + RCS vendors + resellers)
- Reporting: Summary + Detailed + Download Centre + button click + URL click
- Frequency Capping, Time Window (discard/next-day)
- Billing: Category/region-wise WA; Basic/Rich-wise RCS; OneX Currency
- Reseller mode: domain, short URL, logo, embedded signup

Government & International

- Four concurrent deployments: Aura Domestic (V2), I2I (International-to-International), ILDO (International Long Distance Operator), Government SMS
- Active government clients: NICSI, IOCL BSNL, CRIS, ICSI, Indian Bank
- UAE Phase 1 live — first international market deployment
- Plugins: CleverTap, MoEngage integrations live

The V2 Architecture Backbone

```
Inputs:   Campaign UI (Java + React) + gRPC API (Erlang, high throughput) + SMPP +
Plugins (MoEngage / CleverTap)
Core:     Distributed Docker Hubs → Routing Engine → Gateway
Stream:   Kafka (MO / MT / DLR event streaming)
Channels: Meta WhatsApp + Jio RCS + Vi RCS + SMS Operators (Airtel / Jio / Vi / BSNL)
Data:     Doris OLAP (analytics, separated from transactional DB) + PostgreSQL
(transactions) + ODP
Support:  Redis (session cache) + RocksDB (persistent KV) + Media Server + Callback
Server + Billing
```

The architecture is technically sound. Kafka-based event streaming and separated OLAP are the right choices at scale. Distributed Docker Hubs with horizontal scaling remove the single bottleneck risk.

> *The infrastructure is not the problem.*

Part 2 — What's Broken (Now Quantified)

The following findings are confirmed and quantified across 7,139 support tickets and 376 PROD incident tickets raised in the last 7 weeks. Of those 376 PROD tickets, 43% remain open — compared to 13% open in the customer support system. PROD is where the hard, unresolved problems live.

2.1 Customers Cannot Trust Their Own Data

1,841 DELIVERY CONCERN TICKETS · 97 PROD REPORTS/MIS TICKETS · 58 PROD DELIVERY/STATUS TICKETS

The Submitted vs. Delivered count mismatch is the single most-reported problem across every data source. Previously identified as a P0 bug (AURA-8895, AURA-9418), it is now confirmed as an ongoing operational failure, not a discrete bug awaiting a fix.

The concrete evidence: engineers are manually running database commands every few days to update stuck “Awaited” transactions to Delivered or Failed. At least 8 production tickets in the last 7 weeks are exactly this manual ritual — PROD-200, PROD-291, PROD-378, PROD-183, PROD-228, PROD-94, PROD-164, PROD-213. This will not be resolved by a one-time fix; it is a broken automated process being patched by hand indefinitely.

Additionally: two data centres (Ocean DC and Ocean DR) show different counts for the same traffic, compounding the confusion for enterprise customers.

2.2 Reporting Is a Support Cost, Not a Product Feature

1,126 REPORTS SUPPORT TICKETS · 97 PROD TICKETS IN 7 WEEKS

Customers raise support tickets to get their own data because the product does not give it to them self-serve:

- No custom column selection (AURA-11614)
- No scheduled delivery to SFTP or email (generating recurring PROD tickets: **PROD-137 Hero FinCorp, PROD-363 ILDO, PROD-376 OYO, PROD-380 Growtele**)
- Reports load in 30–40 seconds (PROD-301)
- All reports run in IST — blocks UAE and global customers (AURA-9233)
- Account Managers have no visibility into their accounts (P0 gap from teardown, still open)

2.3 Active P0 Issues Confirmed Still Open

Issue	Jira	PROD Confirmation
Customer-facing fallback absent	AURA-10023	PROD-345, PROD-397, PROD-400
Report masking broken	AURA-11388	Still open
Submitted vs Received counts wrong	AURA-9418, AURA-8895	PROD-111, PROD-122, PROD-219
Blacklist/Whitelist granularity	AURA-11548	PROD-175
Campaign failure reason not shown	AURA-11390	PROD-308
Encryption incomplete on WARCS	AURA-11444	Still open

2.4 Enterprise Governance — In Development but Unstable

Maker-Checker and RBAC are being built, but have generated critical bugs immediately upon deployment.

- PROD-311 (Critical): Multiple Issues in Maker Checker Workflow for Campaign Approval and Scheduling Time Validation
- PROD-305 (Critical): Multiple Issues in TUC User Management Roles and Access Control

The task is not greenfield build — it is stabilisation and product-quality delivery of something that already exists in a fragile state.

2.5 Platform Performance

- Login to Ocean DC: 35–40 seconds (PROD-300, Priority: Highest)
- WA/RCS reports page: 30–40 seconds to load (PROD-301, Priority: Highest)
- HTTP 502 — full platform down (PROD-206, PROD-398)
- SMPP WaitTime delays on Ocean DR (PROD-412)

2.6 I2I and ILDO Remain in Sustained Crisis

18 I2I/ILDO tickets in 7 weeks, several Critical and open. The 8–10 hour billing query has not been resolved. Multiple routing errors, wrong report data, and missing CDR logs remain open.

Part 3 — What's Missing Entirely

Unchanged from the initial analysis. Confirmed by support ticket data where noted.

Capability	Status	Evidence
AI / OneX Aura Intelligence	Zero features built despite being the primary marketing claim	No JIRA items, no roadmap
Journey Automation	Entirely absent — CRM integrations exist as a workaround	Plugin integrations confirm customers need this
Email Channel	On the website, not in the product or roadmap	—
Voice / IVR	On the website, not in the roadmap	431 support tickets — real demand exists
Audience Segments	Only flat phonebook — no rule builder, no event history	Limits every campaign to broadcast
Developer Portal	No unified docs, no SDK, no sandbox, no in-UI API key gen	AURA-11608
Unified Cross-Channel Dashboard	Every channel is siloed	Competitors have had this for 2–3 years
365cx.io Contact Centre	Flagship in marketing, absent from roadmap	Unknown maintenance status
Webhook Reliability	No retry logic, no monitoring, no dead-letter queues	PROD-382, PROD-392
Platform SLA Monitoring	Listed as P0, no Jira, not being tracked	Teardown finding

Part 4 — The Competitive Position

The global CPaaS market is valued at $21–23B in 2026, growing at 19–33% CAGR. The 2025 Gartner Magic Quadrant Leaders are Twilio, Infobip, Sinch, and Vonage.

Where Onextel Has a Real, Durable Advantage

- DLT compliance and TRAI alignment — India-specific moat that global players cannot replicate
- Carrier-direct relationships (Airtel, Jio, Vi, BSNL) — delivery rates that international aggregators cannot match
- Government contract base (NICSI, CRIS) — validates enterprise trust
- WhatsApp and RCS feature breadth at ~90–95% of the Meta/Jio/Vi spec
- Multi-provider and reseller architecture — commercially flexible

Where Onextel Is Behind — and the Gap Is Widening

- **AI:** Infobip has AgentOS — generative AI integrated into communication flows. Telnyx is agent-native. Twilio has Conversational Relay for Voice AI. Onextel has nothing.
- **Journey orchestration:** Every Tier 1 player has this. Customers go to CleverTap and MoEngage instead of using Onextel for automation.
- **Developer experience:** Twilio and Telnyx set the standard. Onextel has fragmented API versions and no sandbox.

- **RCS at scale:** Sinch and Infobip have broader carrier RCS coverage. Onextel is limited to Jio and Vi.

The Window

> *Onextel's India-market infrastructure advantage is real. The risk is that Infobip and Sinch are investing in India directly. The window to build the product layer on top of the infrastructure moat is 12–18 months.*

Part 5 — What OneXtel Must Be

OneXtel is the engagement platform that Aura's infrastructure makes possible but never delivered.

> *Aura handles messages. OneXtel handles outcomes.*

The Superset

Capability	Aura Today	OneXtel Adds
Channels	SMS, WhatsApp, RCS	+ Email, + Voice
Campaigns	Bulk broadcast, scheduling	+ Journey automation, + A/B testing, + frequency capping UI

Capability	Aura Today	OneXtel Adds
Templates	Per-channel silos (DLT / WARCS)	Unified library across all channels
Contacts	Flat phonebook	Segments, rule builder, event history
Reporting	Per-channel, often wrong, IST only	Unified, accurate, self-serve, timezone-aware, scheduled delivery
Governance	In development, currently unstable	RBAC + Maker-Checker + Audit Log as a stable, complete module
Failure visibility	Silent failures	Every failure surfaced with reason + suggested fix + alerts
Delivery trust	Counts wrong, manual DB fixes	Accurate funnel, self-serve transaction repair tool
Billing	Per-channel credits	Unified wallet, cross-channel spend dashboard
Onboarding	339 RCS onboarding tickets	Self-serve setup wizard per channel
AI (Product)	Zero features shipped	Intelligent channel routing · Predictive delivery · Anomaly detection · Audience segmentation AI · Conversational flows · Usage & cost insights
Developer	Fragmented APIs, no sandbox	Unified API, in-UI API key generator

Priority Order

#	Problem	Why This Order
1	Data trust — accurate counts, self-serve transaction repair	Every other feature is undermined if the numbers are wrong
2	Reporting self-serve — builder, scheduled delivery, AM view	Converts 1,000+ recurring support tickets into product usage
3	Enterprise governance — stabilise RBAC, Maker-Checker, add Audit Log	Directly unlocks BFSI and Govt deals currently blocked
4	Failure visibility — alerts, error reasons, template sync status	Reduces PROD ticket volume immediately
5	Journey Automation — trigger-based, multi-channel, conditional	Moves OneXtel from broadcast tool to engagement platform
6	Audience Management — contact properties, segments, event history	Prerequisite for Journey and campaign personalisation
7	Unified Content + Templates — across SMS/WA/RCS/Email/Voice	Prerequisite for Journey and multi-channel campaigns
8	Channel onboarding + Email + Voice — self-serve wizards, new channels	Completes the omnichannel story

Part 6 — The Product Organisation Gap

The previous five parts document what is wrong with the product that customers see. This part documents what is wrong with how the product is built. Both need to be fixed. The second determines whether the first ever gets resolved.

6.1 Requirements Arrive Without Structure

Product requirements currently arrive via Slack, email, and hallways. There is no formal intake process. There are no quarterly planning windows. There are no cutoff dates. There is no RICE prioritisation. The result is that priorities are reactive — whoever shouts loudest in any given week shapes what gets built. Strategic problems (the ones costing enterprise deals) wait behind urgent requests (the ones from the loudest customer on a given day).

The consequence is visible in this report: RBAC and Maker-Checker have been listed as P0 on every Aura platform for multiple quarters. They are still not stable in production. Not because engineering can't build them — because there has been no forcing function to protect them from being deprioritised every sprint.

6.2 Support Tickets Are Noise, Not Signal

7,139 support tickets were manually analysed to produce this report. That analysis took significant time and was done once, for this document. It is not a live process. There is no taxonomy. Tickets are not tagged by problem type. There is no mechanism by which support volume — the clearest signal of product failure — flows into product decisions.

The specific breakdown in this report (1,841 delivery concern tickets, 1,126 reporting tickets, 431 voice tickets) was extracted by hand. It should be a dashboard that refreshes automatically and drives the next planning cycle. It currently does not exist.

6.3 Features Enter Engineering Without Design

There is no mandatory design standard before sprint entry. Features are being built without Figma sign-off, without defined edge cases, without empty states, without error states. Issues that should be caught in a design review are instead discovered by the customer or raised as a PROD ticket after release.

PROD-311 (Maker-Checker critical bugs immediately upon deployment) and PROD-305 (RBAC role issues) are partially symptoms of this — governance features with complex interaction states that were built without a structured design process.

6.4 Design and Project Management Need to Be Processified

Design is happening, but it is not yet a formal gate before engineering begins. There is no mandatory sign-off on edge cases, empty states, or error flows before sprint entry. Programme management — tracking roadmap commitments, publishing delivery outcomes, and reviewing what was promised versus what shipped — is not yet formalised at the scale the platform requires.

As the platform matures and enterprise customer expectations grow, both design and programme management need to move from ad-hoc to structured. This is not a criticism of how things have been run — it is a natural next step for a product organisation at this stage of growth.

6.5 Planning Cadence Needs to Scale for 2x Growth

Quarterly planning and PI planning exist. The cadence and rigour that have supported the platform so far will need to be significantly more structured to handle 2x growth in one year. Published roadmaps with org-wide visibility, formal quarterly delivery reviews, and clear cutoff dates for planning windows are the next maturity step — not a replacement of what exists, but a formalisation of it.

The goal is predictability: customers, sales, and engineering should be working from the same product timeline at any given point. That level of shared clarity is what enterprise accounts — and enterprise growth — require.

> *Collectively, these five gaps are a contributing reason that strong infrastructure produces a frustrating product. The operating model problems in Part 6 are not a failure — they are the natural limit of a startup operating model applied to an enterprise-scale platform. The Product Blueprint, attached separately, defines the transition across all seven dimensions: requirements intake, story standards, support taxonomy, design process, team structure, planning cadence, and growth levers.*

Summary

Onextel's infrastructure is an asset. Aura's customer-facing product is a liability — not because it is poorly built, but because it was built for the wrong user.

The support and production data make the cost of the current state concrete: over a thousand customers raising weekly tickets because the product cannot show them their own data; enterprise deals blocked by absent governance features; engineering teams running manual database fixes as a weekly ritual; campaigns failing silently with no customer notification.

OneXtel addresses this with a clear, sequenced plan. The first three priorities — data trust, reporting self-serve, and enterprise governance — do not require new infrastructure. The infrastructure to deliver accurate counts, flexible reports, and role-based access already exists in Aura's backend. What is missing is the product surface that exposes it in a way customers can actually use.

Two documents define what comes next. This report is the diagnosis — grounded in data, covering both what the product is failing to do for customers and what the product team is failing to do internally. The Product Blueprint is the prescription — seven pillars for transitioning from startup mode to growth stage, covering how requirements are gathered, how the team is structured, how AI is embedded into the workflow, and how OneXtel grows.

> *The market window is real. Onextel's DLT compliance, carrier relationships, and government customer base are advantages no global player can replicate quickly. The question is whether OneXtel gets built before Infobip, Sinch, or a well-funded Indian challenger closes the gap on the product layer. The Product Blueprint, attached separately, defines how we build it.*

Sources

OneXtel Product Teardown Phase 1 · Customer Support Ticket Analysis (7,139 tickets) · JIRA PROD (376 tickets, April–May 2026) · JIRA AURA project samples · V2 architecture diagram · CPaaS Competitive Landscape Brief · onexaura.com live product · OneXtel Product Blueprint (May 2026)

Prepared by Udayan Das Chowdhury, Director of Products, Onextel · May 2026